BASELINE → TREATMENT → FOLLOW-UP

Tests and decisions across the treatment course

These are relative stages, not equal time intervals. Additional tests depend on symptoms and the selected chemotherapy source.

Check	Preparation	Cycle 1	Cycle 2	Cycle 3	Surgical review	Follow-up
Treatment	Confirm selected backbone	Day 1 all three	Repeat if appropriate	Final planned cycle	No automatic systemic anticancer therapy (SACT) continuation	Separate plan if further treatment needed
Blood and organ tests	full blood count (FBC), kidney, liver, glucose, thyroid and viral screen	FBC, kidney, liver, glucose	Repeat before treatment	Repeat before treatment	Recovery and fitness checks	Follow unresolved abnormalities
Immune monitoring	Document baseline symptoms	Symptoms before every dose	Thyroid every 3–6 weeks	Cortisol if clinically indicated	Report delayed symptoms	Vigilance at least five months
Support and decisions	Take the prescribed paclitaxel allergy-prevention medicines; your team reconciles steroids with anti-sickness treatment. Carboplatin dosing uses a verified kidney-function measurement; report dehydration or a change in health.	Confirm written prevention plan	Review tolerability	Plan end of chemotherapy support	multidisciplinary team (MDT) agrees imaging and timing	Agree contacts and surveillance

The team arranges and reviews tests. This guide shows expected timing; it does not record completed appointments. National Cancer Control Programme (NCCP) 00849 v2 · official regimen · NCCP 00304 v8 · selected chemotherapy

THE WHOLE TREATMENT JOURNEY

Nivolumab, paclitaxel and carboplatin before surgery: treatment and checks

Neoadjuvant non-small-cell lung cancer (NSCLC) · selected paclitaxel / carboplatin backbone

Up to three 21-day cycles. Day 1: nivolumab, paclitaxel and carboplatin. Then surgical MDT reassessment. The five listed backbones are alternatives; this guide covers only your selected combination.

Read from left to right. Columns show stages, not equal lengths of time. This is a general plan: no dates or personal information are needed. Your team confirms which steps apply and arranges appointments.

Treatment, tests and reviews across the course

Care / check	Preparation	Cycle 1	Cycle 2	Cycle 3	Surgical review	Follow-up
Treatment NCCP 00849 · COMPANION	Confirm selected backbone	Day 1 all three	Repeat if appropriate	Final planned cycle	No automatic SACT continuation	Separate plan if further treatment needed
Blood and organ tests NCCP 00849 · COMPANION	FBC, kidney, liver, glucose, thyroid and viral screen	FBC, kidney, liver, glucose	Repeat before treatment	Repeat before treatment	Recovery and fitness checks	Follow unresolved abnormalities
Immune monitoring NCCP 00849 · COMPANION	Document baseline symptoms	Symptoms before every dose	Thyroid every 3–6 weeks	Cortisol if clinically indicated	Report delayed symptoms	Vigilance at least five months
Support and decisions NCCP 00849 · COMPANION	Take the prescribed paclitaxel allergy-prevention medicines; your team reconciles steroids with anti-sickness treatment. Carboplatin dosing uses a verified kidney-function measurement; report dehydration or a change in health.	Confirm written prevention plan	Review tolerability	Plan end of chemotherapy support	MDT agrees imaging and timing	Agree contacts and surveillance

What each check is for

1 Preparation

Before first infusion

Confirm the exact indication and backbone

Ask / **act:** Complete pathology, molecular, organ-function and consent review.

Sources: NCCP 00849 · COMPANION

2 Each cycle

Before each planned dose

Treatment safety can change

Ask / **act:** Review toxicity, results and the active support plan.

Sources: NCCP 00849 · COMPANION

3 Surgery assessment

After at most three cycles

Coordinate recovery and local treatment

Ask / **act:** Agree surgery timing; no automatic postoperative nivolumab.

Sources: NCCP 00849 · COMPANION

4 Follow-up

During and after surgery

Immune effects may be delayed

Ask / **act:** Keep the immune alert card and report new symptoms promptly.

Sources: NCCP 00849 · COMPANION

At the next review, ask

- Which treatment phase am I in, and what happens next?
- Which test is expected next, who arranges it, and who explains the result?
- Who should I contact if an expected appointment has not arrived?

This map does not show whether a test has been ordered, booked or completed. Do not wait for a scheduled test if you develop new symptoms.

Sources checked 2026-10-29 · Source reconciled; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending · SACTCheck v0.84.27